

MAITHILI NEWS

India's Economic Growth Faces New Challenges Amid Middle East Turmoil

BY BING | BUSINESS | 12 MAR 2026

India has firmly established itself as one of the world's largest economies, maintaining its status as the fastest-growing major economy since 2021. With an annual growth rate consistently exceeding 6 to 7 percent, India is on track to double its economic size every decade. In stark contrast, developed nations such as Germany and Japan struggle to achieve even 2 percent annual growth. However, this economic ascent is now threatened by external geopolitical factors, particularly the escalating conflict in the Middle East.

Recent developments indicate that India's economic landscape is increasingly vulnerable to global disruptions. The ongoing tensions in the Middle East have already had significant reper-

cussions for India, particularly in the energy and aviation sectors. With rising oil prices and supply chain uncertainties, India's energy security is at stake. The country is heavily reliant on energy imports, and any instability in the Middle East could exacerbate the existing pressures on its economy.

Furthermore, the ramifications of this conflict extend beyond energy. The Middle East has long been a crucial source of remittances for India, with over \$50 billion flowing back to the country each year from its diaspora in the region. These remittances are vital for many families, supporting local economies and contributing to national growth. However, as tensions rise, the potential for disruptions in this financial lifeline looms larger.

Economists warn that any significant decline in remittances could dampen consumer spending and hinder economic progress. India's economy has thrived on the back of robust domestic consumption, and a decrease in the inflow of funds from abroad could hinder this momentum at a crucial juncture.

As India navigates its position as an emerging global economic powerhouse, it must also contend with the complexities of international relations and the impact of global conflicts on its economic stability. Policymakers and business leaders alike are urged to monitor these developments closely as they could have lasting implications for India's economic trajectory in the years ahead.

India Navigates Tech Diplomacy Amidst U.S.-China Rivalry

BY BING | TECHNOLOGY | 12 MAR 2026

In a rapidly evolving global landscape, India is positioning itself as a pivotal player in the technology sector, leveraging advancements in artificial intelligence and cybersecurity as instruments of foreign policy. Recently, at the A.I. Summit, Indian officials articulated their vision of casting the nation as a moral authority for smaller, developing countries. This approach not only enhances India's geopolitical influence but also sets the stage for a delicate balancing act between the technological giants of the United States and China.

India's ambitions in the tech arena are underscored by its commitment to ensuring a secure digital environment. A significant development has emerged in the form of 83 proposed smartphone security regulations aimed at major tech companies such as Apple and Google. These rules, part of the Indian Telecom Policy, mandate regular software updates and, in select instances, allow government-approved laboratories to scrutinize source code. This initiative aims to bolster cybersecurity and protect the interests of Indian consumers amid rising digital threats.

The potential implications of these regulations are profound. For companies like Apple and Google, compliance could mean re-evaluating their operational frameworks to align with Indian standards, which may differ significantly from those in their home markets. The Indian government's focus on cybersecurity reflects its broader strategy to enhance digital sovereignty and protect its citizens in an age where technology is inextricably linked to national security.

Furthermore, this regulatory framework places India in a unique position as it navigates its relations with both the U.S. and China. By adopting a proactive stance on technology governance, India is not only safeguarding its own digital landscape but is also asserting its role as a bridge for emerging nations seeking to avoid the pitfalls of technological dependence on superpowers.

As the competition between the U.S. and China intensifies, India's approach could redefine the dynamics of international relations in technology. By advocating for ethical standards and robust cybersecurity measures, India is not merely a participant in the tech race; it is strategically positioning itself as a leader, championing the interests of developing nations in the global tech ecosystem.

India Triumphs Over New Zealand to Secure Third T20 World Cup Title



India's Education System Faces New Challenges and Opportunities

BY STAFF REPORTER | EDUCATION | 12 MAR 2026

India's education landscape is currently navigating a complex interplay of challenges and opportunities that could shape

tinues to recover from the pandemic, policymakers must prioritize not only the restoration of physical classrooms but also the

◆ DAILY HOROSCOPE ◆

♈ ARIES Today, you may feel a surge of energy and enthusiasm. It's a great day to take on new challenges and assert your ideas with confidence.	♉ TAURUS Focus on your financial matters today, as favorable opportunities may arise. Consider investing in something that promises long-term benefits.	♊ GEMINI Your social life shines brightly today. Engage in conversations that inspire you and share your thoughts freely with others.	♋ CANCER Today calls for introspection and self-care. Take time to recharge your emotional batteries and reflect on your personal goals.
♌ LEO Collaboration is key today. Join forces with friends or colleagues to achieve common objectives and elevate your ideas together.	♍ VIRGO Your attention to detail will pay off today, especially in work-related tasks. Stay organized and methodical to achieve success.	♎ LIBRA Creativity flows abundantly today. Embrace artistic pursuits or indulge in any hobby that brings you joy and fulfillment.	♏ SCORPIO Deep conversations and connections are favored today. Open up to those you trust and explore the depths of your relationships.
♐ SAGITTARIUS Adventure awaits! Embrace spontaneity and explore new horizons, whether through travel or learning something new.	♑ CAPRICORN Professional endeavors are highlighted today. Set clear goals and focus on your ambitions to make significant progress.	♒ AQUARIUS Innovation and new ideas are at the forefront today. Don't hesitate to think outside the box and express your unique perspective.	♓ PISCES Emotional clarity is heightened today. Trust your intuition and allow yourself to be vulnerable in your relationships for deeper connections.

? DO YOU KNOW? ?

- ▶ Bananas are berries, while strawberries are not. This is due to botanical classifications where berries are defined as fruits produced from a single ovary with seeds embedded in the flesh.
- ▶ In 1920, the Indian National Congress passed the Non-Cooperation Movement, marking a significant step in India's struggle for independence from British rule, led by Mahatma Gandhi.
- ▶ Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood to the gills, while one pumps it to the rest of the body. They also have blue blood due to the presence of hemocyanin, which is more efficient in cold and low-oxygen environments.
- ▶ The first computer virus, called 'Creeper', was created in the early 1970s. It infected mainframe computers and displayed the message, 'I'm the creeper, catch me if you can!'
- ▶ The Amazon Rainforest produces more than 20% of the world's oxygen, often referred to as the 'lungs of the Earth', and is home to an estimated 390 billion individual trees belonging to around 16,000 species.

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India's Political Landscape: A Legacy of Challenges and Commitments



BY BING | POLITICS | 12 MAR 2026

Indira Gandhi's legacy continues to shape India's political dynamics.

India's political fabric remains deeply influenced by historical legacies and contemporary challenges. Indira Gandhi, a pivotal figure in Indian politics, served as prime minister four times before her assassination in 1984, leaving an indelible mark

on the nation. In the context of regional diplomacy, the recent election of a new government in Bangladesh raises questions about the potential restoration of bilateral relations, which have faced significant strain.

Meanwhile, the India-U.S. trade relationship is undergoing scrutiny, as recent revisions to trade commitments have sparked political debates within both nations. Following a proclamation by former President Trump, India's tariff rate on imports to the U.S. has

been adjusted to 10%, a reduction from 18%. These developments underscore the dynamic and often contentious nature of India's political landscape, both domestically and internationally.

India's Economy Grows Amid Geopolitical Turmoil and Rising Risks



India's economy thrives amid global challenges.

BY BING | ECONOMY | 12 MAR 2026

India continues to solidify its status as the fastest-growing major economy, recording annual growth rates exceeding 6 to 7 percent. This impressive trajectory positions India to potentially double its economic size within a decade, starkly contrasting with the sluggish growth of developed nations like Germany and Japan.

However, the country faces mounting challenges as the ongoing conflict in the Middle East threatens its critical economic sectors. With over \$50 billion in

remittances at stake, alongside vulnerabilities in energy and aviation industries, India's economic stability is under scrutiny. The geopolitical landscape poses risks that could disrupt this remarkable growth, compelling policymakers to adopt strategies that shield the economy from external shocks while striving to maintain its upward momentum.

As India navigates these complexities, the resilience of its economy will be tested in the coming months.

India Navigates Tech Diplomacy Amid Security Challenges



India's tech policies shape its role in global diplomacy.

BY BING | TECHNOLOGY | 12 MAR 2026

At a recent A.I. Summit, India positioned itself as a mediator in global technology governance, advocating for the interests of smaller, developing nations while balancing its relations with both the U.S. and China. This diplomatic stance underscores India's ambition to wield technology as a tool of foreign policy.

Simultaneously, India is implementing a stringent framework of 83 smartphone security rules, aimed at enhancing the cybersecurity landscape. These regulations will require major manufacturers

like Apple and Google to ensure timely software updates and grant access to government-approved labs for source code inspections. This initiative raises significant questions about privacy, security, and the operational capabilities of multinational tech companies in one of the world's largest smartphone markets.

As India asserts its technological influence, both challenges and opportunities loom on the horizon for global tech giants and emerging economies alike.

India Clinches Third T20 World Cup Title Against New Zealand



India celebrates its historic third T20 World Cup victory in Ahmedabad.

BY BING | SPORTS | 12 MAR 2026

In a remarkable display of cricketing prowess, India triumphed over New Zealand by 96 runs to secure the T20 World Cup title for a record third time. The final, held at the Narendra Modi Stadium in Ahmedabad, attracted a raucous crowd of 86,000 enthusiastic fans, who witnessed a masterclass in batting and bowling.

India's victory comes as a sweet redemption, especially for a nation that harbors memories of past disappointments in global tournaments. This win not only underscores India's dominance in the format but also highlights the country's growing stature in international cricket.

As celebrations erupt across the nation, the team's performance has set a benchmark for future competitions, reinforcing India's position as a cricketing powerhouse on the world stage.

◆ DAILY HOROSCOPE ◆

ARIES Today is a day for bold decisions, Aries. Your natural leadership qualities will shine, making it an ideal time to take the initiative in both personal and professional matters.	TAURUS Embrace the beauty around you today, Taurus. Focus on self-care and nurturing your relationships, as these will bring you peace and contentment.	GEMINI Communication flows effortlessly today, Gemini. Engage in meaningful conversations and collaborations that could spark new ideas and opportunities.	CANCER Today calls for introspection, Cancer. Spend time reflecting on your emotional needs and consider how to express them clearly to those you care about.
LEO Your charisma is contagious today, Leo. Use your natural charm to inspire others and lead group activities, as your energy will uplift everyone around you.	VIRGO Focus on organization and planning today, Virgo. Your attention to detail will help you tackle any challenges that come your way with precision and efficiency.	LIBRA Balance is key today, Libra. Seek harmony in your relationships and find creative solutions to any conflicts that may arise, ensuring peace reigns.	SCORPIO Today, trust your instincts, Scorpio. Your intuitive abilities will guide you in making important decisions, especially regarding personal matters.
SAGITTARIUS Adventure awaits you today, Sagittarius. Embrace spontaneity and seek new experiences.	CAPRICORN Today is perfect for setting long-term goals, Capricorn. Your determination and discipline	AQUARIUS Innovation is your forte today, Aquarius. Channel your creative energy into projects that challenge the status quo.	PISCES Your empathy is heightened today, Pisces. Use this sensitivity to connect deeply with others as your

? DO YOU KNOW? ?

- ▶ The world's oldest known living tree is a bristlecone pine located in California's White Mountains, estimated to be over 4,800 years old.
- ▶ In ancient India, the concept of zero as a number was developed by the mathematician Brahmagupta in the 7th century, which revolutionized mathematics globally.
- ▶ Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood to the gills, while the third pumps it to the rest of the body. Interestingly, the heart that delivers blood to the body stops beating when they swim!
- ▶ The Great Wall of China is not a single continuous wall but a series of walls and fortifications built over several centuries, with some sections dating back to the 7th century BC.
- ▶ The first computer virus, known as 'Creeper', was created in the early 1970s and was designed as an experimental program that could move from one computer to another on the ARPANET.

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India and Canada
Reset Ties with
Promising Trade
Agreements



Prime Minister Mark Carney meets with Indian officials in New Delhi.
BY BING | POLITICS | 12 MAR 2026

In a significant diplomatic move, India and Canada are poised to conclude a trade deal by the end of the year. Prime Minister Mark Carney's recent visit to India marks a pivotal step in revitalizing relations, which had been strained in recent years. During his four-day trip, Carney emphasized India's role as a 'natural partner' for Canada, aiming to strengthen economic ties, particularly in the energy sector.

Saskatchewan Premier Scott Moe highlighted that Canada has 'fallen behind' in its trade engagement with India, urging swift action to enhance bilateral trade. The discussions in New Delhi and Mumbai signal a renewed commitment to foster stronger economic collaboration, reflecting both nations' aspirations for a mutually beneficial partnership as they navigate a complex global landscape.

India's Economic
Ranking Under
Scrutiny Amid
Controversial GDP
Figures



Economic data revisions raise questions about India's growth narrative.
BY BING | ECONOMY | 12 MAR 2026

Recent analyses have cast doubt on India's economic standing, challenging the validity of GDP figures celebrated by the government. While officials proclaimed India as the world's fourth-largest economy, revisions indicate it may still rank fifth, trailing Japan by approximately \$300 billion.

Concerns have further escalated due to the shelving of a critical 2019 survey that revealed a decline in rural consumption, raising questions about the government's transparency regarding economic data. Critics argue that these developments suggest a potential suppression of inconvenient facts to bolster a favorable narrative. As India navigates its economic future, the discrepancies in reported growth could have significant implications for policy-making and public trust in economic governance.